it than with instant prints. Both Fujifilm and Instax make instant cameras, and have managed to maintain a presence in the market despite the cost of the film. Many of these are pocketable cameras that double up as wireless printers for your smartphone. Examples include the Kodak Mini Shot Combo 2 and the Fujifilm instax Mini LiPlay. For these retro instant cameras, a regular feature on any point and shoot or a prosumer, such as 1080p HD recording, or at times even an LCD screen to check the image before it is printed, is a bonus. We can expect a series of future instant cameras to incorporate one or two “hero” gimmicks from the regular cameras, thrown in as a bonus to get an edge over competition. The infusion with AI is expected to be universal, so there is no reason that instant cameras should not get smarter, with say the ability to automatically order the next stack of film from Amazon after the current one gets over. Another innovation that can be expected to improve is the Zero ink printing originally developed by Polaroid Corporation in the 1990s, that uses thermal paper containing heat sensitive cyan, magenta and yellow dyes in colourless form. By controlling the intensity and length of heat pulses, the image is formed on the paper, without the use of ink. Zink cameras do not produce images that are as bright or sharp as the instant cameras, but can be expected to improve in the future. Technically, Zink cameras are in their own category, even though they are functionally identical to instant cameras.


The Soumetry Omnipolar 360

The other big thing going forward is film just making a straight up comeback. Kodak has been very active in this area. In 2016 Kodak brought back a reimagined Super 8 camera, with an LCD viewfinder, modifications to shoot in widescreen on the Super 8 film, on board sound recording and a micro HDMI out. Film stock for shooting in different lighting conditions was also made available. What is going on here represents an intelligent effort to marry modern technologies with traditional film photography, an approach that is sure to appeal to film enthusiasts. In 2018, Kodak released the Ektachrome E100 slide film in 35 mm and then in 120mm in 2019. Going forward, we can expect at least Kodak to bring to the market new types of film. We cannot imagine the hype it would create if Canon or Nikon came back to the market with some of their retro products, reimagined with integrated technologies.

COMPUTATIONAL PHOTOGRAPHY AND AI

If there is an AI functionality that most cameras have today, its red eye removal, and that is about it. Consumer cameras are lagging behind smartphones seriously when it comes to computational photography and AI. This may be because most professional photographers

Nikon KeyMission cameras